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Yahoo attacked by hackers; MS acquires Yammer and more news from the web world

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We take a look at apps that will help you find the right jobs and help you in your career

Google's new Android 4.1 Jelly Bean OS detailed

Google introduced the latest version of the Android operating system at its I/O developer event, called Jelly Bean. It's an incremental update to ICS (not Android 5.0 as had been expected), which is aimed to make Ice Cream Sandwich "smoother, faster and more fluid". It mostly brings UI changes ranging from improved notifications and onscreen keyboard, to widget control, voice typing and the native camera app. Most importantly however, are the host of developer changes it brings, which promise to give app-creators greater flexibility and control.

First up, in the list of changes to Jelly Bean, is Project Butter



App widgets on Jelly Bean

– which uses vsync timing and triple buffering to make the touch responsiveness of Jelly Bean devices smooth. Google says that touch responsiveness

has been further improved by predicting where the next touch will be, and in case of a time-out, will use a CPU input boost to ensure minimal latency.

Google has improved the widget-adding experience with Jelly Bean. App widgets can now be automatically resized, depending on where they're dropped on the homescreen, the size to which they're expanded, and the space currently available.

With Jelly Bean, Android notifications will now be interactive, and expanded to show more information, access features, etc., without opening the relevant app. Notifications will now support image content, feature up to three preset actions (such as sharing, or +1-ing) and user-configurable display priority.

Google has introduced Offline Voice Typing to Jelly Bean, placing the previously-cloud-accessed Google Speech Recognizer on the device itself. For now, it only supports U.S. English, but more languages are due later.

Google has made improvements to the native ICS camera and gallery apps as well, with the new Jelly Bean version supporting an undo button, simple deletion UI, and a film strip mode.

Lastly, Google has introduced a Siri-competitor, called Google Now, which uses the Card UI and voice to provide search information, before you search it – something that Google has been advocating for years now. 

MediaTek brings Twitter app to feature phones

Taiwan-based fabless semiconductor company MediaTek has entered into a partnership with Twitter to bring the micro-blogging service to MediaTek-based feature phones. MediaTek will be pre-loading Twitter's smartphone application in its own MRE mid-ware used in feature phone reference designs.

"With MRE, smart-feature phones will be able to run Twitter on minimal memory and hardware requirements, allowing manufacturers and brands to offer price-friendly devices with mobile Internet services", MediaTek said in a release.



The first feature phone design solution to carry Twitter applications will be MediaTek MT6255. The company says the Twitter integration will be available on all MediaTek mobile platforms in the future. It is a win-win situation for Twitter which will be exposed to Chinese and South Asian market. 

Mozilla announces Firefox OS mobile ecosystem

For the past few months, Mozilla has been working hard on their HTML5 and open web standards-based mobile operating system. First announced back in July 2011 as the 'Boot to Gecko' project, Mozilla demoed the

operating system at MWC 2012 and detailed plans for an app store. Now, Mozilla has announced that Boot to Gecko will be known as Firefox OS. It's expected to hit commercially in Brazil in 2013 with the help of Telefonica's brand Vivo and Mozilla Corporation.

Mozilla said that the Firefox OS will be available on new generation smartphones, which will entirely meet open web standards. That means the basic functions of the devices such as calling, messaging, music and games can be developed entirely as HTML5 based applications. 



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